



Quinn Ashby

HEAD GARDENER

“Grows the finest marrows in the county, and holds a grudge just as well.”



✦ FOR YOUR EYES ONLY ✦

OPTIONAL · JOINS AT 6+

WHAT TO WEAR

A flat cap or a headscarf, rolled sleeves, a canvas apron or waistcoat, and a sprig of thistle or wheat in a buttonhole.

At the table you are: plain-spoken, proud of the garden and short on patience for fuss.

How this booklet works



Before the party: read page 2 alone. It holds your story and your secret.



Starter served: open Round 1 on page 3 when the host calls it.



Main course served: unfold page 3 and open Round 2.



Dessert served: open Round 3 on page 4, then vote.

Printed single-sided, so later rounds can't show through.



THE EVENING

Autumn, the 1930s. Bartholomew “Barty” Thistle, retired jam magnate, has invited a few old friends to the Harvest Supper at Thistledown House. Before the soup was served, Barty took a glass of elderflower cordial in the study, sat down for a rest, and never woke up. Someone at this table knows why.

Never show this booklet to anyone. You may bend the truth about your secret, but never about the evidence.



You are innocent.

You did not harm Barty, and you want the truth to come out.

You are an optional character. If you are not in the game, nothing breaks.

Your story

You have been head gardener for twelve years. You make the elderflower cordial every June, bottle by bottle, and you grew the prize marrow Barty meant to show at the county fair.

YOUR SECRET

Barty planned to sell the walled garden to a jam factory. You would lose your work and your cottage. Last week you told Barty, "Over my dead marrows," and half the kitchen heard it.

Where you were

5:50 - 6:20 In the kitchen garden with Barty, weighing the prize marrow.

6:20 Barty went in through the terrace door. You stayed to shut the cold frames.

6:20 - 6:40 Washing up in the potting shed.

6:45 Heard the alarm from the house.

Your goal tonight

Defend your cordial and your garden. Help the table see who was really near that glass. Keep the garden sale quiet until Round 2.

If someone asks you...

“Did you make the cordial?” “Every drop. And every bottle in that pantry is as clean as rain.”

“Where were you?” “In the kitchen garden with Barty, weighing a marrow. It is in Barty’s own ledger.”

“Were you angry with Barty?” “Gardeners are always angry about something. Usually slugs.”

YOUR NOTES BEFORE THE PARTY

[illegible]

Quinn Ashby • Rounds 1 & 2

ONE ROUND AT A TIME



Round 1 • Starter

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Starter is served.

SHARE THIS • I make the cordial every June. Every bottle in that pantry is clean. I would stake my marrows on it.

- I was with Barty in the kitchen garden from ten to six until twenty past six, weighing the prize marrow. Thirty-one pounds.

ASK

- **Morgan:** “Who opened tonight’s fresh bottle, and where did it come from?”
- **Harper:** “Did your famous review mention my garden?”

YOUR TASK Describe your prize marrow to the table in loving detail.



✂ FOLD OR CUT HERE · KEEP ROUND 2 HIDDEN UNTIL THE MAIN COURSE IS SERVED



Round 2 · Main Course

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Main Course is served.

SHARE THIS • Barty meant to sell the walled garden to a jam factory. I was furious, and I won't pretend I wasn't.

- In the garden Barty said to me: “Somebody has been helping themselves to the Trust, Quinn. I’ll have it out tonight.”

ASK

- **Sage:** “Who looks after the Thistle Trust’s money?”
- **Ellis:** “What did Barty seem worried about at five o’clock?”

YOUR TASK Ask the table to guess the weight of the prize marrow. The closest guess gets a toast.

NOTES · ROUNDS 1 AND 2

“MUST SHARE” lines are true and important. Say them during the round, in your own words.

Quinn Ashby • Round 3

THEN VOTE

Round 3 · Dessert

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Dessert is served.

SHARE THIS

- When Barty went in at 6:20, Barty was whistling and perfectly well.
- I have never once been inside the Blue Room. Ask Morgan.

ASK

- **Rowan:** “Will you sell the walled garden now?”
- **Sage:** “Why would anyone hide a note under a saucer?”

YOUR TASK

Before the vote, name one suspect you have now ruled out, and say why.

NOTES

SUSPECTS AT A GLANCE (PUBLIC INFORMATION)

#	NAME	ROLE	#	NAME	ROLE
10	Rowan Thistle	Heir to Thistledown House	14	Harper Vale	Food Critic
11	Ellis Fairweather	Family Doctor	15	Quinn Ashby	Head Gardener
12	Morgan Pike	Steward of Thistledown House	16	Avery Lark	Newspaper Reporter
13	Sage Whitlock	Family Solicitor	17	Jules Marchetti	Visiting Chef